Ze Wang

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University College London, 2024 - Present (expected 2028)

MRes in Economics, University College London, 2023 - 2024

MSc in Economics (Distinction), University College London, 2022 - 2023

BSc in Economics (First Class), University College London, 2019 - 2022

Employment

Research Assistant, School of Management, University College London, 2026 - Present.
Supporting Associate Professor Angela Aristidou (UKRI Future Leaders Fellow; Google Inaugural "AI & Economy" Researcher), where I research AI, the economy, and educational institutions.

Research Fellow, Institute for the Future of Work, 2025 - Present.
Policy research on the future of work and industrial/labour-market policy.

Research Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Oxford, 2025.
Supported Professor Martin Weidner, Professor Raffaella Giacomini, and Associate Professor Irene Botosaru on a working paper in econometrics.

Research Affiliate, Holistic AI, 2024 - Present.
Conducted research on AI bias and fairness (see Selected Publications); co-supervised UCL MSc student projects (AI for Sustainable Development), contributing to papers including Knowledge Collapse in LLMs (arXiv:2509.04796) and LibVulnWatch (arXiv:2505.08842).

Selected Publications

Ze Wang, Zekun Wu, Yichi Zhang, Xin Guan, Navya Jain, Qinyang Lu, Saloni Gupta, Adriano Koshiyama. "Bias Amplification: Large Language Models as Increasingly Biased Media." *Proceedings of IJCNLP-AACL 2025* (Oral).

Ze Wang, Zekun Wu, Xin Guan, Michael Thaler, Adriano Koshiyama, Skylar Lu, Sachin Beepath, Ediz Ertekin, and Maria Perez-Ortiz. "JobFair: A Framework for Benchmarking Gender Hiring Bias in Large Language Models." *Findings of the association for computational linguistics: EMNLP 2024*.
• Media: OECD AI Policy Observatory

Works in progress

Ze Wang, Guobin Shen, and Michael Thaler. "AI Alignment Amplifies the Role of Race, Gender, and Disability in Hiring Decisions." *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.13866*.

Zekun Wu, **Ze Wang**, Seonglae Cho, Yufei Yang, Adriano Koshiyama, Sahan Bulathwela, and Maria Perez-Ortiz. "Tool Calling is Linearly Readable and Steerable in Language Models." *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.07990*.

Ze Wang. "AI Reshapes Human Decision-Making in Hiring."

Michael Thaler and **Ze Wang**. "Chatbots and Political Preference Shifts."

Marcos Vera-Hernandez, Soledad Giardili, and **Ze Wang**. "Who Gets Selected? Systematic Bias in Higher Education Admissions."

Awards, Grants & Presentations

Stone PhD Scholarship, the James M. and Cathleen D. Stone Centre on Wealth Concentration, Inequality, and the Economy, University College London, 2024–2025. Competitively awarded; £10,000 research grant (with a reduced teaching load). Supports research on how AI technologies may perpetuate or amplify inequalities related to demographic characteristics.

CESifo-Transform Workshop on the Economic and Societal Impacts of AI (presenting "AI Alignment Amplifies the Role of Race, Gender, and Disability in Hiring Decisions"), Munich, Germany, December 2026 (forthcoming)

Holistic AI × UCL AI Society Hackathon on AI Safety (presented JobFair paper), London, December 2024

Teaching

UCL: Teaching Assistant, *Statistical Methods in Economics* (ECON0005), 2024/25, 2025/26, 2026/27

Service

Reviewer, ACL Rolling Review (ARR), May 2026

Reviewer, Conference on Language Modeling (COLM) 2026